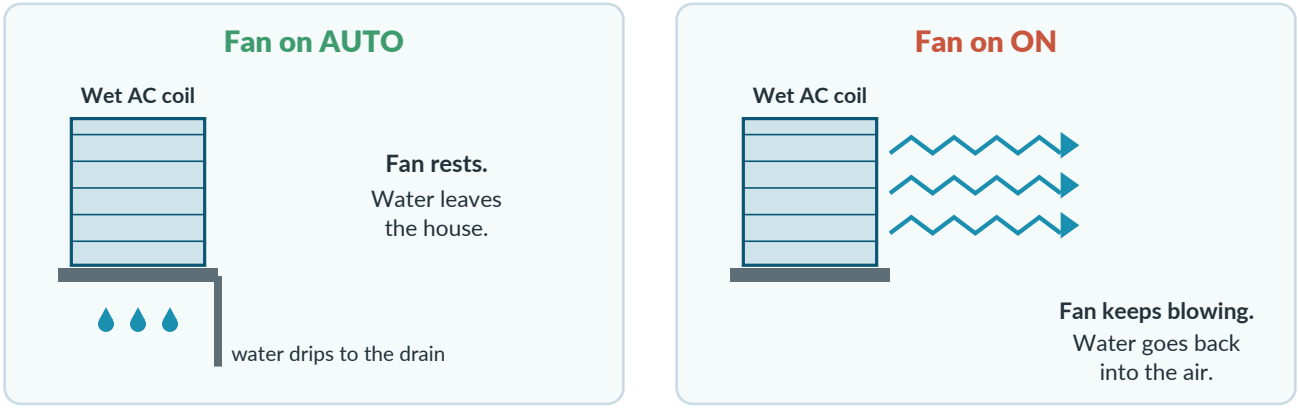
PART 3 OF 11 · LAYER 1: KEEP THE HOUSE DRY

Let the AC do its second job

THE SIMPLE VERSION

The air conditioner is also a water catcher.
It pulls water out of the air and sends it down a pipe.
Set the fan to AUTO so the water goes away and does not come back.



With the fan on AUTO, water on the coil drains away. With the fan ON, the blower blows across the wet coil and puts that water back into the house.

- **Fan on AUTO, never ON.** The Florida Solar Energy Center found that fan ON makes indoor humidity significantly higher. Many systems also keep the blower running 1 to 3 minutes after the compressor stops; ask your HVAC contractor to shorten or disable that delay.[1] DOE guidance calls for 30 seconds or less in humid climates.[2]
- **Bigger is not better.** An oversized AC cools the house fast and shuts off before much water drains off the coil, which leaves the air cool but clammy. If your system short-cycles, ask for a Manual J load calculation before replacing equipment.[2,3]
- **Avoid very cold setpoints.** Setting the thermostat far below normal to feel drier makes supply air and grilles colder, and they can sweat. Fix the humidity instead (see the dew point table in Part 2).
- **Add a dehumidifier** when the AC alone cannot hold the target, especially in the sensitive person's bedroom and during mild spring and fall weather when the AC barely runs. Drain it to a sink or clean the bucket and filter on schedule.
- **Exhaust moisture at the source.** Run bathroom fans during showers and for at least 20 minutes after, use a kitchen hood vented outdoors, and confirm the dryer vents outside.[4] Avoid drying laundry indoors.
- **Keep windows closed on humid days** and let the AC do the work. Humid outdoor air also brings in outdoor mold spores and pollen.[5]
- **No humidifiers or vaporizers** in the home of a mite-sensitive person, and keep houseplants and fish tanks out of the bedroom.[5,6]
- **Keep the AC drain pan clean and the drain line flowing**, and service the system at least yearly.[4]

Your next step

Check that the thermostat fan is set to AUTO today. Ask your HVAC contractor about the blower-off delay and dehumidification settings at your next service visit.

Sources for this part

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